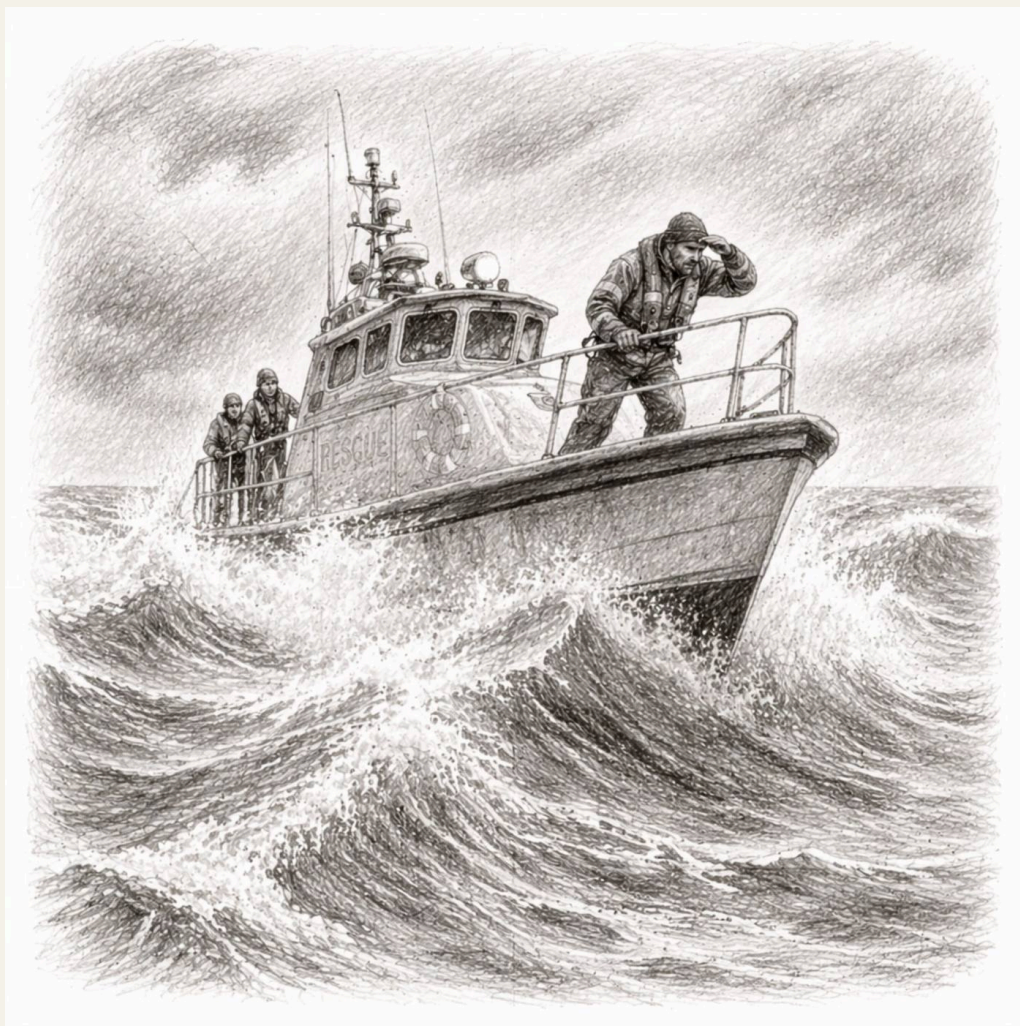


Salvation



A rescue boat climbs a wave that could bury it. The hull says RESCUE. The crew is already in the weather. Nobody on deck is lecturing the drowning about their stroke.

Before you gather

- Read Day 12, Salvation, in The Visual Gospel. Do not reteach the essay.
- Read Exodus 14:13–14, 30–31 in your Bible. The excerpt below is only a backup.

- Your people should already have answered the day's reflection questions. Do not ask those again.
- Leave with a name. The missional challenge only works if someone is named before you pray.

1 · ICEBREAKER · 7 MIN

Open the room

When have you been lost and had to be found, not just given directions?

Leader. The point is rescue, not a map. Then open Exodus 14. God fought. Israel stood still. Say that passing is allowed, especially the first few weeks.

2 · THE WORD · 8 MIN

See it, then say it

IF YOU NEED THE WORDS

Say: Salvation is God rescuing sinners. We do not climb out. Jesus came to die, and God raised Him.

DEFINITION, FROM THE BOOK

Salvation is the gracious and sovereign act of God in which He rescues sinners from sin and judgment through faith in Jesus Christ, restores them to fellowship with Himself, and grants them eternal life by the power of His Spirit.

IN THE ORIGINAL LANGUAGE

Greek *sōtēria* — salvation, deliverance, safety, being brought out.

MEMORY VERSE · ROMANS 1:16

For I am not ashamed of the gospel, for it is the power of God for salvation to everyone who believes, to the Jew first and also to the Greek.

Together, open the flashcard for Salvation. Say the word, the definition, and the verse once. Then put the phone away.

3 · OPEN THE BIBLE · 15 MIN

Exodus 14:13–14, 30–31

Romans 1:16 is the memory verse. Stay in Exodus 14. It is the great picture of God saving a people who could not save themselves. Do not retell the journal.

And Moses said to the people, “Fear not, stand firm, and see the salvation of the LORD, which he will work for you today. For the Egyptians whom you see today, you shall never see again. The LORD will fight for you, and you have only to be silent.” Thus the LORD saved Israel that day from the hand of the Egyptians... and Israel saw the great power that the LORD used against the Egyptians, so the people feared the LORD, and they believed in the LORD and in his servant Moses.

Have two readers if you can. Bibles open. The excerpt is only here so a forgotten Bible does not stop the night.

From the passage

1. In Exodus 14:13–14, what does Moses tell Israel to do, and what does he say the Lord will do? **CORE**

Leader. Fear not. Stand firm. See the salvation of the Lord. The Lord will fight. They only have to be silent — meaning stop trusting their own plan, not hunt for a spiritual feeling.

2. Verse 30 says the Lord saved Israel that day. Who is the subject of the verb?

Leader. The Lord. Not Moses. Not Israel's courage. God saved them. Say that plainly.

4 · AROUND THE ROOM · 20 MIN

A conversation this chapter did not assign

3. Romans 1:16 says the gospel is the power of God for salvation to everyone who believes. How is that the same pattern as the sea?

Leader. God does the saving. Faith receives it. Believing is not the power. God is.

4. Ephesians 2:8–9 says salvation is by grace through faith, not our doing. What “doing” do people still offer God? **CORE**

Leader. A cleaned-up life, a prayer said well, church attendance, being better than someone else. Those are not the sea parting. Christ is.

5. Who around you is still trying to save themselves? What one true sentence will you say to them?

Leader. Salvation is God's rescue through Jesus, received by faith. Not a self-rescue. Get a name.

5 • SAY IT • 5 MIN

In one sentence

Salvation is God rescuing sinners through Jesus, not us climbing out on our own.

Ask for two volunteers, not the whole circle. They may look at the sentence, then try it without looking. Clumsy and true is the goal.

6 • THIS WEEK • 5 MIN

Missional challenge

Before next week, carry this word to someone far from Jesus — a neighbor, a classmate, a coworker, a friend. Do it with a real action and with a true sentence. Name the person before you pray.

Ask someone far from Jesus what they are counting on if they stand before God. Tell them salvation is God's rescue through Jesus, received by faith. Then help them with one real need.

Leader. Keep the help smaller than the Savior. The sentence has to name Jesus. Do not let them offer advice instead of the gospel. Next week, before the icebreaker, take one minute. Who went, and what happened? One sentence. No speeches.

Pray these, and leave room for others

1. Lord, You fight for Your people. We praise You.
2. Forgive us for trusting our own plans more than Christ.
3. Save the one we will name tonight. Give us courage to tell them.

Before you stumble

“Be silent” in Exodus 14:14 is not a call to mystical quiet. It means stop panicking and watch God save. Say that if someone treats silence as the point. And do not tell the room they save themselves by trying harder.

WITH STUDENTS

Ask what they would have done at the sea: swim, fight, or cry. Then read verse 13. God says, “See the salvation of the Lord.”

IF YOU STILL HAVE TIME

Jonah 2:9. “Salvation belongs to the Lord.” Read it if you have a minute. Then pray.